

Proposal Template Guide

Read this page before drafting the proposal.

Template-only page. For the submission PDF, change `\showguidancetrue` to `\showguidancefalse` in `metadata.tex`. This switch removes this page and the blue writing guidance.

Why the proposal is important

- **Alignment:** defines the problem, scope, deliverables, and success criteria for the group, stakeholders (supervisors), and teaching team.
- **Feasibility:** shows that the approach, schedule, resources, budget, and risk controls support completion.
- **Traceability:** connects requirements, specifications, and stakeholder objectives to the design, verification tests, and validation.

Formatting and submission

Page setup: letter paper, 1-inch margins, 12-point sans-serif body text, and 1.5 line spacing. Tables use 12 point font and may use single spacing.

Length: Sections 1–6 have an eight-page maximum. The title page, executive summary, contents, references, and appendices are excluded.

Figures and tables: number, caption, cite, and discuss each figure and table. Use appropriate units and significant digits. Choose relevant diagrams appropriately and ensure they convey your message with enough detail, using context provided in the body of the report.

Final check: remove guidance; replace bracketed fields, placeholders, and the sample logo; update citations; confirm the page count; spell-check; and submit on onQ.

Systems engineering in this proposal

The following definitions from the *International Council on Systems Engineering (INCOSE) Systems Engineering Handbook*, published by the [INCOSE](#), convey the systems engineering (SE) perspective used in this proposal.

Systems engineering.

SE is an interdisciplinary approach and means to enable the realization of successful systems. It focuses on defining customer needs and required functionality early in the development cycle, documenting requirements, and then proceeding with design synthesis and system validation while considering the complete problem: operations, cost and schedule, performance, training and support, test, manufacturing, and disposal. SE considers both the business and the technical needs of all customers with the goal of providing a quality product that meets the user needs.

Systems engineering effort.

SE effort integrates multiple disciplines and specialty groups into a set of activities that proceed from concept to production and operation. SE considers both the business and the technical needs of all stakeholders with the goal of providing a quality system that meets their needs.

International Council on Systems Engineering [1, Sec. 1.5]

How the proposal is graded

The proposal will be graded with an eye towards model-based systems engineering (MBSE): diagrams, figures, and tables should convey technical information. The body of the text should introduce ideas, state their purpose, assumptions, and limitations, provide reasoning for decisions, and interpret the information shown. More generally, the proposal is graded based on appropriately communicating engineering design, using the rubric on the next page.



Logo example: `figures/sample_logo.png` is a generic sample. Set `\ProjectLogo` in `metadata.tex` to the team's image path, or leave it empty for a cover without a logo.

Dimension	Grading evidence
Problem, objectives, and scope	Stakeholder, system-context, use-case, objective, or requirements models define the need, system boundary, actors, operating environment, measurable objectives, scope, assumptions, and constraints. The executive summary and introduction explain the problem / motivation, project trajectory, deliverables, and how the proposed end product addresses the identified problem.
Functional description and traceability	Functional-decomposition, system block, interface, information-flow, signal-flow, state, activity, or sequence diagrams communicate system behaviour and structure. Consistent identifiers trace stakeholder needs → requirements → functions → components and interfaces. The text adequately explains these models.
Design, production, resources, and feasibility	Physical and logical architectures, function-to-component allocation models, trade-study tables, dependency networks, work-breakdown structures, milestone or Gantt diagrams, risk models, and resource or budget models show an implementable approach. The text justifies design choices, calculations, production methods, resources, budget, division of labour, contingencies, and the sequence of three to five credible milestones.
Verification and validation	Requirement traceability matrix, test flow charts, experimental test setup figures, timing or sequence diagrams, and / or other figures show how evidence progresses from components to subsystems and the integrated system. The text describes each prototype, states test methods, equipment or software, conditions, measurable acceptance criteria, required evidence, and why the planned tests sufficiently verify requirements and validate stakeholder needs.
Writing, formatting, and references	Every diagram has a descriptive caption, readable labels, defined symbols, units, directions, interfaces, requirement identifiers, and cited sources where applicable. There is consistency in terminology and identifiers. The title page, executive summary, contents, formatting, citations, and references are complete, clear, and professionally presented.

SMITH ENGINEERING

Queen's University

Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering



ELEC 490/498 Project Proposal

[Project title]

Fall 2026 / Winter 2027

WRITING TEMPLATE

Submitted by Group [Group number]

Group member	NetID	Student number
[Name 1]	[NetID]	[Student number]
[Name 2]	[NetID]	[Student number]
[Name 3]	[NetID]	[Student number]
[Name 4]	[NetID]	[Student number]

Faculty supervisor(s): [Supervisor name(s)]

Supervisor email: [Supervisor email address(es)]

Submission date: [Day Month Year]

Version: [Version]

Template setup: replace the bracketed fields and develop each section into a written project proposal. Include the industry partner when applicable.

Executive Summary

Aim for approximately three-quarters of a page. Summarize the project, the contents of this proposal, two or three main milestones, and the estimated total cost. Write this section after drafting the body.

[Paragraph 1: Identify the problem, intended users or market, proposed system, and expected benefit. State the project goal and the end product.]

[Paragraph 2: Summarize the principal functions and performance targets, the proposed design and production approach, and two or three milestones.]

[Paragraph 3: List the prototypes. Summarize the testing approach, resources and total estimated cost in the stated currency, and readiness to begin the project. If further research and / or learning is necessary, list the topics and their applicability.]

It's not necessary to follow the structure above. This is just a recommendation.

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Include this page if applicable:

List of Figures

1	[System architecture and information flow. (This is a generic example. Use several diagrams to show the various relationships between system components.)]	2
2	[Proposed system testing approach...be more specific here.]	4

Include this page if applicable:

List of Tables

1	Preliminary system specifications.	2
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Acronyms

INCOSE International Council on Systems Engineering

MBSE model-based systems engineering

SE systems engineering

1. Introduction

The body of the completed proposal, i.e. Sections 1–6 below, has a maximum length of eight pages; the title page, executive summary, contents, references, and appendices are not included in this limit.

In the intro below, establish the wider problem you are trying to address, project's scope in the context of this problem, the general design, and limitations.

Change the titles of these subsections as you see fit. We have just provided some example placeholders.

1.1 Inefficiencies in unilateral phase detractors

Describe the problem, the intended end user or market, evidence of the need, and the value of addressing it. Support the context with several citations from peer-reviewed literature [2].¹ Feel free to change the section titles to fit your project. This section is the 'Problem and Purpose' section.

1.2 Retro-encabulator design for inverse reactive current

State the specific objectives and measurable outcomes that address the problem. Characterize the electrical and / or computer engineering involved. Support your claims by describing similar approaches in the peer-reviewed literature. Include a general diagram showing the system context. Compare your approach to those in the peer-reviewed literature. This section is the 'Project Objective' section.

1.3 Deliverables: Power production, elimination of side-fumbling, and reduction of sinusoidal depletion

This is a refinement of Sec. 1.2. Define the end product or products, the operating context, system inputs and outputs, and the major components. Explain each component's purpose and how the components fit together. State the project boundaries and assumptions. Address several limitations of your approach. Provide citations in the peer-reviewed literature and / or textbooks that apply similar strategies. This section is the 'Scope and deliverables' section.

¹Not exactly a peer-reviewed source, but I wanted to put an example reference somewhere :)

2. Functional Description

2.1 System overview

Use a set of diagrams to explain the system boundary, internal functions, operating behavior, inputs and outputs, signal types, protocols, direction of information flow, computing architecture, and / or anything else that applies. Write a short paragraph here that explains design decisions and references each figure, like Figure 1. Maintain labeling consistency (such as IDs, components, units, etc.) across tables and figures in this document. It's a good idea to reference these later in Section 4.

Show the functional, physical, and logical diagrams.
Label components, inputs, outputs, arrows, and signal types or protocols.

Figure 1: [System architecture and information flow. (This is a generic example. Use several diagrams to show the various relationships between system components.)]

2.2 Interface and performance specifications

Give quantitative targets and tolerances with proper units. You can also use IDs to connect specifications with the tests in Section 4. Write a short paragraph here giving context for these requirements, citing the IDs as necessary.

Table 1: Preliminary system specifications.

ID	Requirement	Target	Tolerance
IF-01	[Interface]	[Value; unit]	[Range]
PF-01	[Performance]	[Value; unit]	[Range]

2.3 Risks and safety hazards

Identify relevant technical risks, health risks, and / or safety hazards, and indicate how you will manage these risks, and / or explain how system features and operating conditions are low-risk.

3. Design and Production Approach

3.1 Retroencabulator development

Describe the sequence of design, analysis or simulation, prototyping, construction, integration, and refinement. Explain the team's preparation and the rationale for the approach. This is the 'development process' section.

3.2 Milestones and division of labor

*Plan at least five technical milestones. Give each milestone a date, an observable completion condition, and one responsible member as the primary lead. Course report and presentation deadlines do **not** belong here. This table tracks technical progress!*

Table 2: Technical milestones and ownership.

ID	Milestone	Due date	Lead
M1	All six hydrocoptic marzelvanes functioning with the ambifacient lunar waneshaft	[Date]	[Name]
M2	Sidefumbling test complete	[Date]	[Name]
M3	Tremie-pipe functioning with differential girdlespring	[Date]	[Name]
M4	Fluorescence score motion tested with dinglearm	[Date]	[Name]
M5	Testing and validation of retroencabulator complete	March 15, 2027	all members

Add one or two explanatory sentences per milestone, and describe completion evidence and dependencies where applicable.

3.3 Contingencies

Identify likely technical or scheduling obstacles, the trigger for taking corrective action, any alternative approaches, and the expected effect on time and cost.

4. Testing and Evaluation

Describe how the team expects to test the proposed system. The purpose of this section is to show that testing has been considered, not to provide a complete test procedure. (This you will do in the blueprint.) Use a diagram to communicate the overall test approach and briefly explain the expected evidence of success.

Insert diagrams showing the test environments, and link IDs to the requirements and specifications.
Show what will be tested, the main inputs and measurements, and how the results connect to the project requirements.

Figure 2: [Proposed system testing approach...be more specific here.]

Requirement	Proposed test	Expected evidence of success
[ID]	[Briefly describe the planned test.]	[State the expected result or pass criterion.]

List as many verification and validation tests as you can think of at this time. Briefly identify any equipment, software, facilities, or special conditions expected to be needed. Explain how the tests will help determine whether the final system meets its main requirements (verification) and stakeholder needs (validation).

5. Resource Requirements

5.1 Scheduling access to resources

Connect the technical milestones to laboratory space, equipment, fabrication, software, subscriptions, repositories, and other resources. Discuss access with the supervisor and include booking or lead-time requirements.

Table 3: Resource access by milestone.

Milestone	Resource / source	Access date / lead time
M1	[Tools and design resources]	[Date; lead time]
M2–M3	[Lab; equipment; fabrication]	[Date; booking]
M4	[Test equipment and facilities]	[Date; booking]

You can also relate each resource to the verification tests, or any other aspect of your report. Try to make use of labels / IDs so that they can be referenced consistently across the report.

5.2 Materials and other resources

Estimate costs in CAD. Include quantities and the basis for estimates; identify resources supplied through existing access. Include tax, shipping, and contingency where applicable.

Table 4: Preliminary cost estimate (CAD).

Item / source	Qty.	Unit cost	Total
[Hardware / supplier]	[n]	[Cost]	[Cost]
[Software / service / access]	[n]	[Cost]	[Cost]
[Tax; shipping; contingency]			[Cost]
Estimated total			[Total]

[State the cost assumptions, access arrangements, and supervisor or industry contributions. Explain the funding and availability needed to complete the project.]

6. Conclusion

Summarize the project and the evidence established in Sections 1–5. End with the expected contribution and the team’s readiness to proceed.

[Identify the proposed system and its purpose. Recap the objectives, scope, principal specifications, design strategy, milestones, testing approach, resources, and estimated cost. Close with the expected benefit for the intended user or application.]

7. References

Replace these entries with the sources used in the proposal. Include previous project reports, papers, books, data sheets, and web resources as appropriate. Supply enough information to retrieve each source. Cite external claims, data, and adapted figures, and record permission or license details for reused material.

- [1] International Council on Systems Engineering, *INCOSE Systems Engineering Handbook: A Guide for System Life Cycle Processes and Activities*, 4th ed., D. D. Walden, G. J. Roedler, K. J. Forsberg, R. D. Hamelin, and T. M. Shortell, Eds. Hoboken, NJ: John Wiley & Sons, 2015, ISBN: 978-1-118-99940-0.
- [2] Rockwell Automation. “Rockwell retro encabulator.” YouTube video, originally produced in 1997. (Jan. 16, 2008), [Online]. Available: <https://youtu.be/RXJKdh1KZ0w> (visited on 09/08/2026).

A. Supporting Schedule and Technical Material

Use appendices for a detailed timeline or Gantt chart, supporting calculations, data sheets, or additional diagrams. Cite each included appendix from the body.

[Insert the detailed schedule or supporting material.]